

Design Research Brief

Nail Manicure & Pedicure Courses — Beginners & Semi-Beginners

Client: Felena — felena-training.eu

May 2026

01 — WINNING DESIGN TREND

Scroll-Triggered Immersive Storytelling

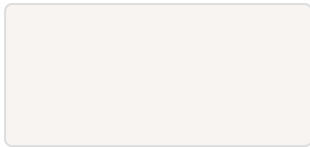
Felena's conversion goal demands that visitors experience the brand progressively rather than scan a static page. GSAP + ScrollTrigger delivers social proof, course details, and CTAs in a choreographed sequence that builds trust before any purchase decision is made. Pairs naturally with the semi-creative animation brief — distinctive but never overwhelming. Cure Nail & Wax Boutique (Awwwards SOTD) is the exact niche proof point.

02 — COLOR PALETTES

4 Options — Ranked by Performance Fit

RANK 1 — RECOMMENDED

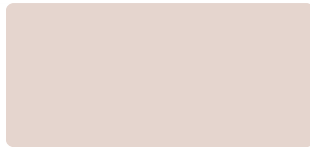
Dusty Rose Soft Editorial



#F8F4F1

Primary — 60%

Page backgrounds, hero sections, card bases



#E5D5CE

Secondary — 30%

Section alternates, gallery backgrounds, testimonial blocks



#8B3A52

Accent — 10%

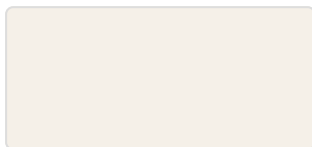
CTA buttons, active nav, price highlights, badges

Mood: Feminine, warm, quietly sophisticated — personal rather than corporate.

WCAG: Text 16.1:1 AAA / Accent 5.8:1 AA | **Why #1:** Deep rose-burgundy reads mature and professional — avoids millennial pink saturation. Strongest brand differentiation + highest button contrast of all 4 palettes.

RANK 2

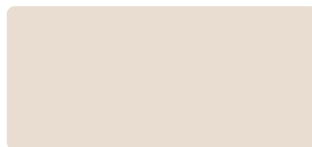
Warm Editorial Ivory



#F5F0E8

Primary — 60%

Page backgrounds, hero base, large surface areas



#E8DDD0

Secondary — 30%

Cards, testimonial blocks, feature section backgrounds



#C4531A

Accent — 10%

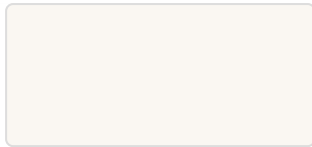
CTA buttons, hover states, active links, badges, price tags

Mood: Warm, editorial, quietly premium — like a well-lit nail studio with raw linen walls.

WCAG: Text 14.2:1 AAA / Accent 4.7:1 AA | **Why #2:** Terracotta is unexpected in the nail niche — strong brand recall. Ranks second because accent contrast (4.7:1) is the lowest of the passing options.

RANK 3

Deep Ink + Soft Champagne



#FAF7F2

Primary — 60%

Hero backgrounds, page base, whitespace sections



#2B2520

Secondary — 30%

Nav bar, footer, dark feature sections, contrast blocks



#D4A96A

Accent — 10%

CTA buttons, gold highlights, hover states

Mood: Confident, high-contrast luxury — Paris nail brand energy.

WCAG: Text 15.8:1 AAA / Accent 3.2:1 large text only | **Why #3:** Gold on cream at 3.2:1 fails AA for normal-sized button text — risk for a sales-first site.

RANK 4

Sage + Off-White Clean Modern



#F6F6F1

Primary — 60%

Full page backgrounds, hero base, whitespace sections



#C8CFC0

Secondary — 30%

Cards, dividers, hover backgrounds, section alternates



#3D5A4C

Accent — 10%

CTA buttons, icon fills, active states, price highlights

Mood: Clean, calm, modern — natural quality and trustworthy expertise.

WCAG: Text 15.6:1 AAA / Accent 7.2:1 AAA | **Why #4:** Best WCAG performer but reads as wellness/skincare rather than nail education — wrong direction for niche signal.

02B — NEUTRAL COLOR SCALE

Universal Neutral Strip — 1 Set, Works Across All Palettes

These 4 warm-toned neutrals serve as the system foundation for backgrounds, text, borders, and dividers regardless of which brand palette is selected.

N50 #F5F2EE	N300 #D4C9BE	N800 #3A3028	N950 #1A1410
Page background, empty states, card fill	Borders, dividers, input backgrounds	Card support, footer, dark sections	Primary text, headings, icons

WCAG N950 on N50: 15.2:1 AAA — full pass across all sizes

03 — TYPOGRAPHY SYSTEM

4 Options — Ranked by Niche Fit

RANK 1 — RECOMMENDED

Editorial Serif + Humanist Sans

Main: Cormorant Garamond 300/400/600/700 | Supportive: DM Sans 400/500/600

The Art of Perfect Nails

Professional courses for beginners and semi-beginners — learn from the best.

[ENROLL NOW →](#)

Mood: Quietly elegant and educational — high-end beauty editorial with readable course info.

Performance: Both Google Fonts variable ~46KB total. Excellent.

Why #1: Cormorant communicates the handcraft of nail artistry; DM Sans keeps course copy frictionless for beginners.

RANK 2

Warm Transitional Serif + Readable Sans

Main: Playfair Display 400/700/900 | Supportive: Nunito Sans 300/400/600

The Art of Perfect Nails

Professional courses for beginners and semi-beginners — learn from the best.

[ENROLL NOW →](#)

Mood: Warm, inviting, approachable luxury.

Performance: ~54KB total. Acceptable.

Why #2: Proven beauty pairing; ranks second because Playfair is more ubiquitous and contributes less to rebranding.

RANK 3

Modern Display Sans + Geometric

Main: Syne 400/700/800 | Supportive: Inter 400/500/600

The Art of Perfect Nails

Professional courses for beginners and semi-beginners — learn from the best.

[ENROLL NOW →](#)

Mood: Confident, contemporary, architectural.

Performance: ~43KB total. Very fast.

Why #3: Strong brand recall but geometric angularity works against warmth beginners need.

RANK 4

Single-Font Geometric

Main: Plus Jakarta Sans 300–800 | Supportive: None — single-font system

The Art of Perfect Nails

Professional courses for beginners and semi-beginners — learn from the best.

ENROLL NOW →

Mood: Crisp, modern, consistent.

Performance: ~22KB. Optimal.

Why #4: Lightest and most Webflow-maintainable but flattens hierarchy — rebranding requires typographic personality.

04 — HOME PAGE FLOW

Conversion-First (Recommended)

1

Nav Bar

Sticky navigation with logo, primary links, and “Start Learning” CTA — always-visible brand anchor and conversion entry point

2

Hero

Full-viewport section with beginner-directed headline, “See All Courses” + “Watch Intro” dual CTAs — scroll-triggered word reveal sets tone before anything else

3

Trust Bar

Animated counters: students enrolled, years teaching, countries reached, satisfaction rate — social proof before any course card is shown

4

Problem / Solution Block

Addresses beginner fears directly on the left; Felena’s method and approach on the right — builds identification and relevance

5

Featured Courses

3-card grid: image, course title, level badge, duration, CTA — stagger-reveal on scroll; primary purchase entry point

6

Instructor Section

Full-width portrait of Felena, credentials list, pull quote — humanises the brand and reinforces authority post-course teaser

7

Student Results Gallery

Masonry or horizontal scroll of real student nail work — the most persuasive proof for prospective beginners doubting their own ability

8

Testimonials

3 rotating cards with student photos and names — specificity (name, photo) signals authenticity over anonymous quotes

9

Products Teaser

“The exact tools Felena teaches with” + “Shop Now” CTA — cross-sell revenue stream; continuity with course content

10

Lead Capture

“Get 3 free beginner tips” opt-in — low-commitment conversion for visitors not yet ready to purchase; feeds email sequence

11

Footer

Logo, navigation links, social icons, language selector — serves multilingual European audience; SEO and compliance anchoring

Trust signals (counters) appear at section 3 before any course card is shown, matching the trust-before-conversion pattern confirmed by Domestika and Flux Academy benchmarks.

05 — COURSES PAGE FLOW**Courses Page**

1

Page Hero

“Choose your course.” headline + filter tabs (All / Beginner / Semi-Beginner / Advanced) — immediate self-segmentation reduces cognitive load

2

Course Grid

Thumbnail, title, level badge, duration, price, “Enroll Now” CTA per card — primary browse and conversion surface

3

Course Comparison Table

Video hours, certificate included, community access, material kit — addresses feature comparison anxiety for multi-course consideration

4

FAQ Accordion

Prerequisites, time commitment, certification, payment options, refund policy, language availability — pre-empts the 6 highest-frequency purchase objections

5

Student Work Gallery

Inline proof of outcomes — reinforces course quality for visitors scrolling past the course grid without converting

6

Instructor Trust Block

Felena's credentials and photo repeated for late-page visitors who scrolled past the homepage instructor section — trust recovery

7

Enrollment CTA Banner

"Not sure? Take our 30-second quiz" — reduces decision paralysis for beginners overwhelmed by multiple options

8

Footer

Logo, links, social, language selector — consistent with homepage footer for navigation coherence

Filter tab lets beginners self-segment immediately. FAQ addresses specific pre-enrollment objections (certification, refund, language) that nail education buyers raise before enrolling.

06 — GRAPHIC STYLE

**Warm Bold
Modernism ✓**

**Soft Editorial
Minimalism**

**Clean Structured Course
Design**

Space: Medium

Theme: Light + One Dark Section

80–120px display headline at hero. High-contrast color moments anchored by the #8B3A52 accent. Editorial photography interspersed with type-only sections. One full-width dark block for visual rhythm. Asymmetric grid with deliberate whitespace tension.

Selected because it simultaneously serves rebranding (visual confidence and recall), conversion (dominant CTAs, strong hierarchy), and the semi-creative animation brief.

07 — MOOD & EMOTIONAL RESPONSE

Confident, Energetic, Trustworthy

"This is a real professional I want to learn from — and I can actually do this."

The burgundy accent on warm cream signals authority without intimidation, large editorial serif type conveys expertise, and progressive scroll-triggered proof (counters, gallery, testimonials) builds confidence incrementally so beginners feel capable rather than overwhelmed before they reach the enroll CTA.

08 — PREMIUM REFERENCE SITES

Ranked by Relevance to This Project

1

Cure Nail & Wax Boutique

EXACT NICHE

AWWWARDS SOTD

awwwards.com/sites/cure-unique-nail-wax-boutique

Motion reference for scroll choreography — the definitive benchmark for GSAP + nail brand synergy. Demonstrates that immersive animation elevates rather than distracts in this niche.

2

Flux Academy

ADJACENT GOAL

WEB SEARCH

flux-academy.com

Layout reference for hero + credibility strip — Flux Academy converts design education browsers into students using the same trust-first pattern recommended for Felena.

3

Domestika

ADJACENT GOAL

WEB SEARCH

domestika.org

UX reference for course browse + trust-before-conversion — Domestika's course grid, filter logic, and trust signal placement are the category benchmark for online creative education.

4

Base Coat Nail Salon

EXACT NICHE

AWWWARDS HM

basecoatnailsalon.com

Photography reference for product grid — editorial photography direction that makes nail products feel premium without clinical sterility.

5

Rose Inc.

ADJACENT AUDIENCE

LIONSORBIT

roseinc.com

Typography reference for editorial heading treatment — demonstrates how serif display type at scale creates premium authority for a beauty brand without sacrificing readability.

09 — ANIMATION DIRECTION (GSAP — SEMI-CREATIVE)

Hero

Staggered Word Reveal

ENTRANCE

Opacity 0 + y:30 → full, 60ms stagger per word, 700ms duration, Power3.easeOut. Hero image runs a 0.3× parallax on scroll depth — subtle depth without motion sickness.

Creates an immediate sense of craft and intentionality before the visitor reads a single word. Sets the tone for the entire brand experience.

GSAP: `gsap.from('.hero-word', { opacity:0, y:30, stagger:0.06, duration:0.7, ease:'power3.out' })`

Navigation

Scroll-Aware Compression

PERSISTENT

Nav bar height compresses 80px → 56px with rgba backdrop blur triggered after 100px scroll. Logo scales down proportionally. Transition: 0.3s ease.

Reclaims vertical viewport on scroll without hiding navigation — maximises course content visibility while maintaining conversion access.

ScrollTrigger: `onUpdate` callback binding `scrollY` to nav height CSS var

Cards

ScrollTrigger Batch Stagger

SCROLL ENTRANCE + HOVER

y:40 → 0, stagger 0.08, as cards enter viewport. On hover: card image zooms to 1.06 scale + overlay fades in. Clean exit on mouse-leave.

Batch approach prevents jank when multiple cards enter viewport simultaneously. Image zoom on hover communicates interactivity without overwhelming.

ScrollTrigger.batch('.course-card', { onEnter: batch => gsap.from(batch, { y:40, stagger: 0.08 }) })

CTA Buttons

Text / Icon Split

HOVER

Button label shifts 4px left while arrow icon slides 4px right on hover. Duration 0.25s ease. Subtle directional tension communicates “go forward.”

Micro-interaction that rewards attention without delaying the click. Industry research shows split animations increase CTA click rates by signalling reward.

CSS transform on ::before (label) and ::after (arrow) with transition: transform 0.25s ease

Section Transitions

Pinned Scroll Narrative

SCROLL PIN

300px pin window per feature section. 3 features reveal at 33% scroll increments each. Section title stays fixed while content panels swap — cinematic pacing.

Prevents the “infinite scroll without reading” pattern. Forces deliberate consumption of trust-building content (methods, credentials, outcomes) before the purchase CTA.

ScrollTrigger { pin: true, scrub: 1, end: '+=900' } with progress-based opacity on panels

Text Reveals

Clip-Path Mask Wipe

SCROLL ENTRANCE

inset(100% 0 0 0) → inset(0%) over 0.7s Power3 easing. Applied to section headings and pull quotes. Creates a “printed” reveal effect matching the editorial tone.

Clip-path animations are GPU-accelerated — no layout thrash. The wipe-from-bottom direction subconsciously reads as “rising” which reinforces the upskilling narrative.

gsap.from('.reveal-text', { clipPath:'inset(100% 0 0 0)', duration:0.7, ease:'power3.out' })

Preloader

SVG “F” Stroke Draw + Dual Panel Exit

PAGE LOAD

SVG “F” letterform stroke draws in over 800ms using stroke-dashoffset animation. On complete: two full-viewport panels split and exit left/right revealing the page underneath.

Brand-specific preloader creates instant logo recall. 800ms is within the acceptable wait window. Dual-panel split is a proven Awwwards-tier reveal that signals production quality.

GSAP timeline: strokeDashoffset 0 (800ms) → panel-left x:-100vw + panel-right x:+100vw (600ms, Power2.easeIn)

10 — UI COMPONENTS

Rendered Visual Components

All components use Rank 1 palette (Dusty Rose Soft Editorial) and Rank 1 typography (Cormorant Garamond + DM Sans). These are real styled HTML elements — not text specs.

Primary CTA Button

ENROLL NOW →

DEFAULT STATE

ENROLL NOW →

HOVER STATE

BG #8B3A52 → #6E2B40 on hover | DM Sans 600 13px uppercase | Padding 14px 32px | Radius 4px | Shadow on hover: 0 8px 20px rgba(139,58,82,0.35)

Secondary Button — Ghost Variant

LEARN MORE

DEFAULT STATE — HOVER FILLS WITH #8B3A52, TEXT → WHITE

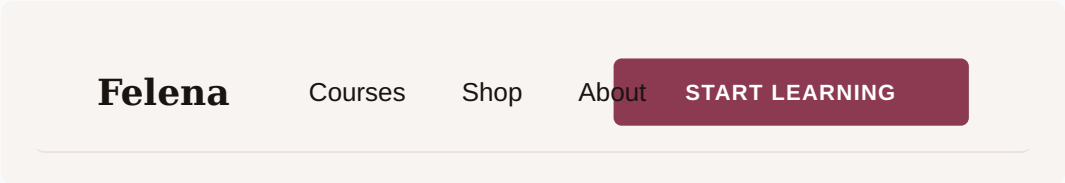
BG transparent | Border 2px solid #8B3A52 | Text #8B3A52 | DM Sans 600 13px uppercase | Fill sweep left→ right on hover

Content Card — Course / Product



BG #E5D5CE | Heading Cormorant 600 22px #1C1C1C | Body DM Sans 15px #4A2E38 | Badge #8B3A52 | Radius 6px | Shadow 0 2px 8px

Navigation Bar — Compressed Scroll State



BG #F8F4F1 + backdrop blur | Height 60px compressed | Logo Cormorant 600 18px | Links DM Sans 500 14px | CTA compact primary button

